

directed that "no structure on the road, road junctions and roadside land, crossings which impede vision or hampers traffic movement or is otherwise hazardous and a nuisance be placed or installed". The court had also directed that the "the safety of traffic can be ensured only if the visibility is full and unimpeded along both sides of the roads. Any obstructions should be clear of the minimum visibility triangle for a height of 1.2 m [3 ft] above the roadway." Former advocate-general

President Raja Ram and General Secretary Babu Singh Kushwaha if she was arrested in the wake of an adverse judgement of the Supreme Court in the disproportionate assets case. Even Union Home Minister P. Chidambaram has slammed the Uttar Pradesh chief minister on the issue. He said that the huge sum of money spent on constructing statues could have been used to provide basic amenities to the people. BJP's H.N. Dixit too joined the fray when he said that the state Government had

projects like Bara and Karchana near Allahabad as well as the input based franchisee power distribution system in Kanpur and Agra to be implemented through private-public partnership. It was only after the recent debacle in the Lok Sabha polls that the BSP government had begun to think over creating a strong infrastructure to push Uttar Pradesh into the league of developing states. Mayawati, according to official sources, had realised that the main reasons for her party's poor

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MAYAWATI DIDN'T LIKE THE
ORIGINAL STRUCTURE**



MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

and SP Rajya Sabha MP Virendra Bhatia, who had filed the petition in 2005, points that it is the first time that the apex court has issued notices against legislative sanctions of the funds. Besides, the Supreme Court has indicated that it might have some tough questions in store for the state Government. He also indicated that some senior officers, who had violated the court order, might be booked on contempt charges.

These are tough times for Mayawati. Only a few days ago, she had directed party office-bearers across the country to take instructions from Vice-

done nothing for the state's development. He claims that the chief minister has admitted in public that the funds for the statues and parks came from the PWD which meant that the funds for roads and other development activities have been eaten up by these memorials.

It was a fact well known that Mayawati only talked of projects that were difficult to implement like the 165-km-long Yamuna Expressway between Greater Noida and Agra, the Ganga Expressway, the eight-lane mega project linking Ballia in the far east to Greater Noida near Delhi traversing 1,047 km, besides big power

showing was the lack of development and governance. Only last week, the Government put in place a high-level body and robust mechanism to accelerate the implementation of infrastructure development projects on a priority basis. But the Leader of Opposition in the State Assembly Shivpal Yadav said this was nothing but to mislead the public and create an impression that she also thinks of development. "Everyone knows that she undertook most of the projects only for personal gains and to etch herself in the people's consciousness," he said. In stone, of course. **with Subhash Mishra**